The Rope Around the Bow

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 4, Episode 10

Nib secured the mooring and found that the cart would not move. The rope ran through its handle space. The boat was tied, but so was the book cart. Lark kept the boat end attached while studying the route diagram for the line.

“The cart is very securely moored,” Nib admitted ruefully. “Let us moor the boat,” Lark suggested gently.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

> **book**

“Ou in out and ow in cow can write the same moving vowel sound,” Lark modeled clearly. “Read out, cow, and brown. The title's word bow needs its own spoken meaning from me today; we don't have to guess an unfamiliar use from a familiar-looking team.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try out, cow, brown. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Read out on the diagram,” Lark invited gently. “Where should the line pass in relation to the cart route?”

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

> **The brown cow is out. A book is on the cart.**

“What is outside?” Lark asked softly. “Which sentence describes the animal?”

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

Nib moved the loose section outside the cart's travel space and around the proper bow fitting. The boat end stayed attached throughout the change. Lark checked the mooring before the cart rolled again. At Farm Quay, the next request card showed a railway picture and the title of the book its reader wanted.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write out beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

Your journal showed the boat held steady and the cart free. Two useful jobs no longer competed for the same space. The Farm Quay request could now be prepared without an accidental rope around its delivery cart.